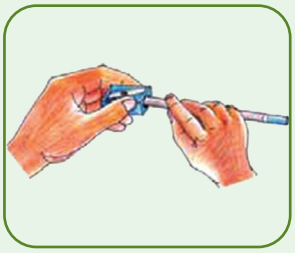
2.2. Types of motion

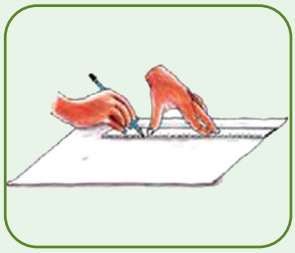
Activity 4

Play with pencil

Do what Shanthi did...

(i) Shanthi took a pencil and sharpened it with a sharpener. (ii) Then she drew a circle using the pencil and a compass. (iii) Later she took her ruler (scale) and drew a straight line in another paper. (iv) Then she kept the pencil between her fingers and moved it back and forth.






Now, look at the motion of the pencil in all these four cases. How was it?

(i) In the first case, the pencil **rotated in its axis.**

(ii) In the second case, it went in **a circle.**

(iii) In the third case, the pencil travelled in **a straight line.**

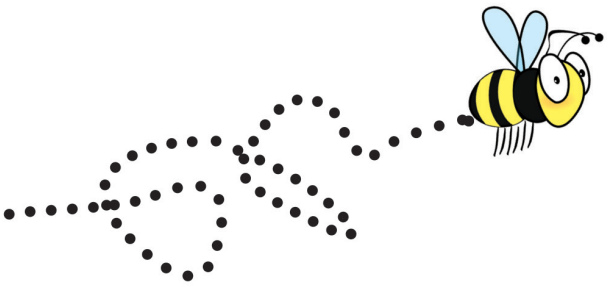
(iv) In the fourth case, the pencil tip moved **back and forth,** that is it oscillated like a swing.

We can say that the motion of the pencil was rotational, circular, straight line or linear and later oscillatory.

Throw paper aeroplanes or paper dart. Watch its flight path when you throw it at an angle. The path curves i.e the paper flight is moving ahead but its direction is changing while moving. Such paths are called curvilinear.



A fly buzzing around the room is a combination of all these motions and flight path is zigzag.



You can classify the motion according to the path taken by the object.

a. Linear motion - Motion in a straight line.
   Eg. A person walking on a straight path.